

Stop Female Cat Spraying — Action Checklist

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CONFIRM THE BEHAVIOR

- ☐ **Confirm Spraying Behavior:** Watch your cat during urination and verify she's spraying on vertical surfaces with her tail raised, because distinguishing territorial marking from ordinary house soiling determines whether this guide applies to your situation.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Schedule a vet appointment and specifically request a urinalysis and urine culture, not just a general wellness exam, because hidden urinary tract infections can cause spraying that looks behavioral but requires antibiotics to resolve.
- ☐ **Ask About Arthritis:** Request that your vet palpate your cat's joints during the physical exam, especially if she's an older spayed female, because arthritis pain can make litter box access uncomfortable and trigger avoidance spraying that mimics territorial marking.
- ☐ **Watch for Emergency Signs:** Contact your vet immediately if you notice straining with little urine output, crying during urination, blood in urine, or lethargy combined with urinary symptoms, because these indicate a potentially life-threatening urinary blockage requiring emergency care.

CLEAR MEDICAL CAUSES

- ☐ **Apply the n+1 Litter Box Rule:** Set up one litter box per cat in your household plus one additional box, and place them in separate locations throughout your home, because inadequate litter box availability is one of the most common triggers for territorial spraying behavior.
- ☐ **Upgrade to Larger Boxes:** Replace standard litter pans with oversized plastic storage bins with an entry hole cut in the lid, because sprayers need extra room to position themselves properly and standard pans are typically too small for comfortable back-spraying posture.
- ☐ **Identify Stress Triggers:** Walk through your home and note any recent changes including new pets, new people, rearranged furniture, outdoor cats visible through windows, or construction noise, because accumulated low-level stressors create chronic anxiety that drives spraying behavior.

- ❑ **Commit to a 4-Week Trial:** Set a calendar reminder to wait at least four weeks before deciding whether any intervention is working, because cat behavioral changes happen gradually and judging pheromones, litter changes, or medication too early leads to abandoning effective solutions prematurely.

FIX THE ENVIRONMENT

- ❑ **Check the Full Guide:** This step is described in detail in the companion guide — open stop-female-cat-spraying_v1.md and review the relevant section.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.